ALAGAPPA UNIVERSITY, KARAIKUDI – 630 003
(Accredited with A+ Grade by NAAC (CGPA:3.64) in the Third Cycle)

Date : 20.12.2017

30th Convocation of Alagappa University

The 30th Convocation of Alagappa University was held on Wednesday, the 20th of December 2017 at 2.00 p.m. in the University Convocation Hall.

Hon'ble Governor of Tamil Nadu and Chancellor of Alagappa University Thiru. Banwarilal Purohit presided over the function and gave away the degrees to the new graduates.

Hon'ble Minister for Higher Education, Government of Tamil Nadu and Pro -Chancellor of Alagappa University Thiru K.P. Anbalagan graced the occasion and offered felicitations.

Prof. T.P.Singh, Distinguished Professor and INSA Senior Scientist All India Institute of Medical Sciences, New Delhi, delivered the Convocation Address

Prof. S. Subbiah, Vice-Chancellor, Alagappa University, delivered the Welcome Address and recounted the activities and programmes of the University.

In this Convocation, Thiru Ramanathan Vairavan, an Eminent Educationist, and the grandson of Dr. Alagappa Chettiar, was honoured with Doctor of Literature (Honoris Causa) by the Chancellor in recognition of his contribution to education and to the fields of Pharmacogenetics and Molecular Oncology. Prof. S. Karutha Pandian, a senior Professor of the University was awarded the D.Sc. Degree. Since the inception of the University, for the first time, D.Sc. Degree was conferred in this convocation.

A total of 32,787 students were conferred with the degrees, of which 11,375 graduates were male while 21,412 were female. In this convocation, 295 candidates consisting of 156 Ph.D. research scholars, 47 M.Phil. scholars from the University Departments and Affiliated Colleges, 50 Post Graduate and 41 Under Graduate students from the University Departments and Affiliated Colleges and one D.Sc. scholar received their degrees in person.

Moreover, 29 gold medalists received their Gold Medals from the Hon'ble Governor of Tamil Nadu. It included, 8 M.Phil. students from the University Departments, 18 Post Graduate students from the University Departments, 2 Under Graduate students from University Constituent Colleges and one from Affiliated College.

Thiru K.R. Ramasamy, MLA and Thiru H. Raja, Former MLA and Thiru Sunil Paliwal, I.A.S., Higher Education Secretary, Government of Tamil Nadu, graced the occasion by their presence.

Before the convocation, tree saplings were planted by the Hon'ble Governor and Hon'ble Minister for Higher Education and Higher Education Secretary near the Vallal Alagappar Memorial Temple. RUSA Garden opposite to the Central Library was declared open by the Hon'ble Governor-Chancellor.

In his Welcome Address, Prof. S. Subbiah, Vice-Chancellor, recounted briefly the significant activities that happened at the University during the year 2017. He said the University Library System has been modernized and strengthened at a cost of Rs.175 lakhs during this period and it has established a Digital Education Cell to promote the MOOCs courses in SWAYAM Platform among the students. The University Science Instrumentation Centre (USIC) established recently has Rs.19 crores worth of the state-of-art instruments for science research. Alagappa University's own Research Fund (AURF) has been increased to Rs.7 crore from Rs.5 crore. Scholars of the University are provided financial assistance for presenting papers abroad. University has embarked on inter-disciplinary and inter-institutional project on the submerged ancient portcity of Poompuhar. The project to be led by the Alagappa University involves over 40 scientists and 14 academic and research institutions in India. A number of faculty members of Alagappa University have been honoured with awards in recognition of their

research and services by other institutions. 21 faculty members visited foreign countries for their academic works. A number of scholars and teams from abroad have visited the University. The University entered into 8 MoUs with Universities abroad and signed 15 MoUs with Indian Universities and Institutions. During this year, 12 International, 43 National Seminars and Conferences were organized, besides numerous endowment lectures and special lectures by scholars. A Tamil Culture Museum has been established as part of the Centre for Tamil Culture. 5660 students are pursuing various programmes of study at the University campus. A Yoga Centre has been established at a cost of Rs.56 lakhs. Swami Vivekananda Centre for Higher Education and Research is actively propagating the secular ideals of the sage.

Hon'ble Minister for Higher Education Thiru K.P. Anbalagan, Govt. of Tamil Nadu, while offering his felicitations, said that the Tamil Nadu tops the list in the enrollment of students in higher educational institutions with 44.2 percent. The State, he said, gives prime importance to women's education and he was happy to note that 75% of students in Alagappa University are women. Twenty Four Universities of Tamil Nadu find a place in the top 100 Universities in India. He added that there are 53 Universities in Tamil Nadu, of which 22 are State

Universities and 28 are Deemed Universities and three institutions – IIT, NIT and IIM -- are Central Government Institutions. Of the 816 Universities in India, 367 are State Universities. Of these 367, 32 State Universities **are eligible to apply for the status of "Institution of Eminence"**, as per MHRD. Alagappa University is one among these 32 Universities. He added that 11 new colleges have been started by the Tamil Nadu Government in this academic year and a total of 76 Colleges have been started during the last five years and he also said the former Chief Minister J.Jayalalithaa evinced keen interest in starting colleges and the good work is carried on by the present Chief Minister Edapadi Palanichamy. He exhorted the new graduates to utilize all their energy and skills for making India a highly developed one among the comity of nations. Self-confidence, duty-consciousness, respect to elders, morally inclined behaviour and showing compassion to the needy will help them to lead an ideal life of happiness. He congratulated Alagappa University for obtaining Green and Clean Campus Award from NICER and also for getting the 3rd place in the Swatchchatha Ranking at the national level. That 14 new Departments of study have been started during the last two academic years speaks of its progress, he added.

While delivering the Convocation Address, Prof. T.P. Singh Distinguished Professor and INSA Senior Scientist, All India Institute of Medical Sciences, New Delhi, said that India is a young nation with nearly 40 million people in the age group of 10 to 25. Our country's real wealth lies in this population. If this human resource is "well- educated, well-trained, and well-transformed", we would be able to provide commendable service to the whole world. He stated that in this regard, Institutions of Higher Learning and Research have a crucial role to play in making India a real knowledge hub of the world. Lauding Alagappa University for its achievements such as A+ grade by NAAC, ISO 9001 Certification for providing quality education and research, Clean and Green campus award, and 3rd place in Swachhta Ranking 2017, he added that Alagappa University has done well on the research front. The increase in 'h' index in the last five years from 22 to 60 speaks of its climb.

He stated that the future of economies of countries is very much dependent on pharmaceutical industry. It is a knowledge–based and human resource-intensive field. Emphasizing the team work, he said that Alagappa University with the cooperation of the Departments of Chemistry, Bio-Technology and Bio-Informatics can play a crucial role in this sector as it has already taken valuable lead in drug discovery research.

Today, the Universities need "MENTORS" as chief executives for their growth and "the demography of their faculty should be as wide as possible". Besides Mentors, he stated, they needed very efficient faculty in large numbers for their growth and concrete contribution to society by their research. Only a mentor can bring in development in an institution; and in this connection he cited the example of Madras University which was nurtured by Mentors during 1950s and 1960s. Eminent Researcher Prof. G.N. Ramachandran and his team were encouraged by the then Mentor–Vice-Chancellors of the University and as a result they made substantial contributions in the field of Science. He said he could find the "indication of this mentoring approach in Alagappa University". He concluded his speech by stating that "this approach is essential for promoting scientific research and its applications for the welfare of the entire mankind".

The Governor-Chancellor and the Higher Education Minister visited Vallal Alagappar Museum and the Tamil Culture Museum, which has been established as part of the Centre for Tamil Culture.

Prof. V. Balachandran

Registrar i/c.